



JOKES WITH SO AND SUCH



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:

1HDT-B1L5-264



1

Warm up

Read the information and then answer the question.

A comedy roast is an event where people gather together to talk to and about a special guest, usually someone famous or important, like a celebrity or a CEO. This event usually features what is called "insult comedy," so people might make fun of the guest's character or appearance, but they also say some positive things. The guest knows in advance that this will happen and so they give their consent. However, if it goes too far, some of the jokes might be seen as bullying.

This lesson is joke-themed. What are some guidelines to follow to make sure everyone is laughing, and no one is left out or hurt?





2

Focus on vocabulary

Part A: Match the nouns to the correct adjective.

couch potato
egghead

genius
fat cat

big shot
fossil

cheapskate
lazybones

dinosaur
miser

dragon
monster

rich, wealthy	ancient, old	cheap, mean	scary	lazy	smart, wise
_____ 1	_____ 2	_____ 3	_____ 4	_____ 5	_____ 6
_____ 7	_____ 8	_____ 9	_____ 10	_____ 11	_____ 12

Part B: Now, answer the questions below.

- Which nouns have an /ai/ sound?
- Do you know any other adjectives or nouns with the same meanings?

3

Listening

Part A: You are going to listen to a radio show. Look at the extracts below and write up to five missing words in each gap.



- We haven't had _____ entries this time...
- You're _____ your wallet counts as carry-on luggage when you fly.
- You're _____ that your golf cart has a built-in caviar dispenser.
- ...it costs _____ that only rich people can afford to eat it.
- You're _____ that you use \$100 bills as napkins.
- You're _____ you play Monopoly with real cash.
- You tell those jokes _____ ...

Part B: Now, answer the questions below.

- What concept do the four jokes share?
- Which joke do you think should win the \$50 prize?



4

Language point

So and **such** add emphasis to sentences. Tick the correct boxes to show how we use these words – you can look back at the sentences in the last exercise to help.

So:

- ☐ + adjective
- ☐ + adverb
- ☐ + a/an + adjective + singular C noun OR + adjective + plural C noun or U noun
- ☐ + much + U noun OR + many + plural C noun
- ☐ + a lot of + plural C or U noun

Such:

- ☐ + adjective
- ☐ + adverb
- ☐ + a/an + adjective + singular C noun OR + adjective + plural C noun or U noun
- ☐ + much + U noun OR + many + plural C noun
- ☐ + a lot of + plural C or U noun





So/such can express cause and effect. We can join the clauses with the word *that*, but it's not necessary.

CAUSE	EFFECT
You're <u>so</u> rich...	... (that) your wallet counts as carry-on luggage when you fly.
You're <u>such</u> a fat cat...	... (that) your golf cart has a built-in caviar dispenser.

We stress *so* and *such* in sentences like this:

You're so rich your wallet counts as carry-on luggage when you fly.

You're such a fat cat that your golf cart has a built-in caviar dispenser.

Practice saying these sentences with the correct stresses:

You're so wealthy that you use \$100 bills as napkins.

You're such a big shot you play Monopoly with real cash.

5

Practice

Complete the sentences using *so/such* and the word in brackets. You can add an article if you need to. Which of these jokes do you think is the funniest?

Group 1:

1. You're _____ that your birth certificate is written in Roman numerals. (*adj., old*)
2. You're _____ even Einstein was impressed. (*n, genius*)
3. You're _____ you make ice cubes jealous. (*adj., cool*)
4. You're _____ you walked into an antique store, and they didn't let you leave. (*adj., ancient*)
5. You're _____ you have to take a shower in Niagara Falls. (*n, giant*)

**Group 2:**

1. You're _____ you went into a haunted house, and they handed you an application. (*adj., scary*)
2. You're _____ that you knew Burger King when he was a prince. (*n, dinosaur*)
3. You're _____ that when you play basketball you have to lie down to put the ball in the hoop. (*adj., tall*)
4. You're _____ Google uses YOU! (*n, egghead*)
5. You're _____ that you gave me something from my own closet as a birthday present. (*n, miser*)

Extra challenge: rephrase some of the jokes so that *so* becomes *such* or *such* becomes *so*, as in this example:

- You're **so old** that your birth certificate is written in Roman numerals.
- You're **such a dinosaur** that your birth certificate is written in Roman numerals.

**6****Speaking**

Work in A/B pairs. Look at the correct page of the worksheet.



Student A: Complete each of your jokes with one or two missing words. Then tell the jokes to your partner – they can say whether you have the right word or not. They may want to give you a clue if you don't have the right answer using the useful language box. At the end, choose the funniest joke together.

1. You're so cheap you won't even pay _____.
2. You're so old that you took your driving test on a _____.
3. You're such a lazybones that you stole your girlfriend's _____ just so you could spend more time with her.
4. You're such a monster the government moved Halloween to your _____.
5. You're such an old-timer your _____ is in black and white.
6. Your house is so small you have to go outside to change _____.

Useful Language for Giving Clues:

- There are two words.
- The first letter of the word is...
- The word has two/three syllables.
- You need a verb/adjective/noun.

Student B's Missing Words:

1. eat it outside
2. late for work
3. trash cans
4. for advice
5. a fork
6. alarm



Student B: Complete each of your jokes with one or two missing words. Then tell the jokes to your partner – they can say whether you have the right word or not. They may want to give you a clue if you don't have the right answer using the useful language box. At the end, choose the funniest joke together.

1. You live in such a tiny house that when you order a large pizza, you have to _____.
2. You're so lazy you work from home and you're still _____!
3. You're so mean you have burglar alarms on your _____.
4. You're so wise that Yoda comes to you _____.
5. You're such a cheapskate that you eat cereal with _____ to save milk.
6. You're such a fossil you walked out of a museum and the _____ went off.

Useful Language for Giving Clues:

- There are two words.
- The first letter of the word is...
- The word has two/three syllables.
- You need a verb/adjective/noun.

Student A's Missing Words:

1. attention
2. dinosaur
3. ID
4. birthday
5. memory
6. your mind



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Optional extension

Part A: There are lots of phrases which use *joke* in English. Read the sentences and match each phrase in bold with its meaning.

1. All right everybody, **all joking aside**, we need to get some work done now.
 2. Ha ha – it's not so funny when the **joke's on you**, is it?
 3. I love working with you, because you always **crack jokes**, even when things are really difficult.
 4. I won the lottery? No way, **you must be joking**.
 5. It's important to be able to **take a joke** and laugh at yourself.
 6. Ok, this is **beyond a joke** now.
 7. We have **a running joke** about Tom Cruise, because she told me once that she liked him.
 8. My sisters and I used to **play** all sorts of silly **practical jokes** on my parents when we were kids.
- a. introduces a serious statement after some humor
 - b. say funny things
 - c. a joke about the same subject that continues over a long period of time
 - d. laugh when someone says something funny about you without being offended
 - e. I don't believe you
 - f. these rely on physical humor rather than words
 - g. you've tried to make another person look bad, but it didn't work, and you are the one who looks bad now
 - h. something is no longer funny, and the situation is getting really serious

Part B: Answer the questions.

1. Can you think of any examples of practical jokes?
2. Do you have any running jokes with anyone? What are they about?
3. Are there any occasions when you shouldn't have to take a joke about yourself?



Transcripts

3. Listening

- Speaker A:** Welcome back to Lunchtime with Lou. We've just listened to a bit of music, and now it's time for the joke of the day. Remember, yesterday we asked you for jokes with the so/such format. We haven't had so many entries this time – only four people sent in their ideas. Let's see if they're any good. Can you read the first one, please?
- Speaker B:** Sure. It goes like this: You're so rich your wallet counts as carry-on luggage when you fly.
- Speaker A:** Ha! Not bad, but actually, I've heard it before. What's the next one?
- Speaker B:** Okay, the next one is: You're such a fat cat that your golf cart has a built-in caviar dispenser.
- Speaker A:** I don't get it. What's caviar?
- Speaker B:** You've never heard of caviar? Really? It's a fancy food – actually fish eggs – and it costs such a lot of money that only rich people can afford to eat it.
- Speaker A:** I see. Well, I don't think it works all that well. Can you do any better?
- Speaker B:** I'll try. How about this one: You're so wealthy that you use hundred-dollar bills as napkins.
- Speaker A:** Hmm.
- Speaker B:** Well, I liked it. Here's the final joke: You're such a big shot you play Monopoly with real cash.
- Speaker A:** (laughs) You tell those jokes so well... Ok, so only one can win the fifty-dollar prize. Listeners time to phone in and say which one wins your vote – lines are open now. Let's listen to some more music while we're waiting...



Key

1. Warm up

5 mins.

This lesson requires some preparation to contextualize the jokes and ensure that everyone has a good time. Go over the text and work with the whole class to establish some guidelines.

Note that the activities do not offer opportunities for students to offend each other during the lesson. However, if you worry that your class might make some off the cuff remarks, refer back to this stage to help them remember to keep things inclusive and positive.

Sample answer: Avoid othering marginalized groups on the basis of race, religion, gender, income, sexuality, etc. Also avoid references to personal appearance and any other subject which individuals might be sensitive about. It's only funny if everyone feels like laughing.

2. Focus on vocabulary

Part A

5 mins.

Students review and extend the vocabulary they will need in the lesson. Set the task and demonstrate with one item. Students continue – they could use dictionaries if they need to. Check answers and pronunciation – stressed syllables are underlined.

mean – unwilling to spend money

- | | | | | | |
|--------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|
| 1. <u>big</u> shot | 2. <u>dino</u> saur | 3. <u>chea</u> pskate | 4. <u>dra</u> gon | 5. couch <u>pot</u> ato | 6. <u>ge</u> nious |
| 7. <u>fat</u> cat | 8. <u>foss</u> il | 9. <u>mis</u> er | 10. <u>mon</u> ster | 11. <u>lazy</u> bones | 12. <u>egg</u> head |

Part B

5 mins.

Pose the follow-up questions.

1) dinosaur, old timer, miser

2) Students' own answers. Confirm if their ideas sound natural in English and point out if any suggestions would be hurtful, because they have negative connotations.

3. Listening

Part A

5 mins.

Students listen to the recording. They focus on the target language: so/such.

- | | | | |
|---------------|--------------------|-------------------|------------------------|
| 1. so many | 2. so rich | 3. such a fat cat | 4. such a lot of money |
| 5. so wealthy | 6. such a big shot | 7. so well | |

Part B

5 mins.

Students listen again. They identify the main theme of the jokes (being rich and using so/such), and choose the funniest one.



4. Language point

10 mins.

Students formulate the rules for so/such based on the examples from the previous exercise.

Note: C = countable, U = uncountable

So:

- ☒ + adjective
- ☒ + adverb
- ☒ + much + U noun OR + many + plural C noun

Such:

- ☒ + a/an + adjective + singular C noun OR + adjective + plural C noun or U noun
- ☒ + a lot of + plural C or U noun

5. Practice

10-15 mins.

Students complete the jokes to practice the target language. Demonstrate with the first item. Students can then check answers in pairs before you check with the whole class – be prepared to answer vocabulary questions. Ask them which joke is the funniest and pose the extra challenge if you have time.

Group 1:

- | | | |
|---------------|------------------|------------|
| 1. so old | 2. such a genius | 3. so cool |
| 4. so ancient | 5. such a giant | |

Group 2:

- | | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|------------|
| 1. so scary | 2. such a dinosaur | 3. so tall |
| 4. such an egghead | 5. such a miser | |

6. Speaking

10-15 mins.

Set up A/B roles and make sure students are looking at the correct page. They can work in A+A/B+B pairs to predict the missing words. Then they recombine into A+B pairs and take turns to tell the jokes to each other and confirm the answers. Encourage them to give clues to one another to help arrive at the right answer rather than simply telling each other the words.

They choose the funniest joke – when you elicit responses, make sure they are saying the sentences with natural sentence stress. If you have time, students can invent their own jokes. Ensure they keep it positive. If they want to use a negative adjective like dumb, they should tell the joke about themselves, e.g. *I'm so dumb that...*

Student A

- | | | |
|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| 1. attention | 2. dinosaur | 3. ID |
| 4. birthday | 5. memory | 6. your mind |

Student B

- | | | |
|-------------------|------------------|---------------|
| 1. eat it outside | 2. late for work | 3. trash cans |
| 4. for advice | 5. a fork | 6. alarm |



7. Optional extension

Part A

5 mins.

This is a filler or cooler activity if you have time in your lesson. Go over the instructions – guessing meaning from context is a very important language learning skill which requires practice. Students can work alone or in pairs to complete the exercise. Check the answers.

1. → a. 2. → g. 3. → b. 4. → e. 5. → d. 6. → h. 7. → c. 8. → f.

Part B

5 mins.

Students discuss the questions below.